TOWN OF THUNDERBOLT
REGULAR MONTHLY MEETING
WEDNESDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2024
6:00 PM

AGENDA HEARING

Public has five minutes per person to ask questions or comment on any agenda item.
Mayor Williams opened the public hearing up at 6 pm.

Town Administrator Milie discussed the work being done at Nellie Johnson Memorial Park. He explained the plan and progress regarding bushes and trees is to start with a blank slate to build upon. He stated public input is still needed for ideas moving forward. He wishes the park ideology to reflect the Town's beliefs, needs, etc. He would like to see upgraded safety, new equipment, and a more welcoming and accommodating park for residents to enjoy. Mayor Williams added the Town is still in the planning process and input is still being taken and is much needed.

Bob Greenberg, new resident, asked about community group meetings for improvement. He was directed to the Thunderbolt Community Improvement Association.

Katherine Clemens, 3224 Cedar St. – Ms. Clemens stated Nellie Johnson Memorial Park is named after her great-great grandmother. She has been waiting forever for improvements to be made at the park. She applauds the Town for doing the work and is appalled at the negative Facebook comments others are making regarding the work.

Beth Goette, 3006 Leonard St. – Stated there was an error on the website and an error on the agenda date listed. Town Clerk Walker thanked her for the information.

Sue DeRosa, 3215 Bannon Dr., stated her concerns with planting native plants at the park. Those plants are hard to find locally. She recommends doing more research for plant choices. She also suggested alternative irrigation methods, including collection of rainwater for irrigation purposes.

Meredith Allen, 3220 Falligant Ave., stated public outreach is necessary. The removal of bushes and plants without community involvement upset her. She says it shows a lack of community. She feels a better approach is needed, possibly surveying the community. She suggested setting up a process to get input without making residents go out of their way to participate.

Town Administrator Milie asked to speak with Ms. Allen individually to get her input.

Mayor Williams closed the public comment at 6:38 pm.

REGULAR MEETING

1. **Call to order -** Mayor Williams called the meeting to order at 6:43 pm.

2. **Roll Call by Presiding Officer with Invocation, followed by the Pledge of Allegiance**

In Attendance is Mayor Dana Williams and Council Members: David Crenshaw, Larry Ward, Edward Drohan, James Lavin, Bethany Skipper-Greer, and Brooks Barbaree. Staff in attendance: Town Administrator, Bob Milie; Police Chief Sean Clayton, Public Works Manager, Oscar Crosby; Town Attorney, Charlie Barrow; Accounts Payable/Utilities Manager; Katina Spaulding; Town Clerk/Zoning Administrator, Matthew Walker.

Not in attendance Fire Chief Andrew Bateman.

3. **Approval of Amended Meeting Agenda (correcting the date in the agenda header and adding Roger Moss Presentation)**

Mayor Williams asked for a motion to approve the amended agenda. **Council Member Crenshaw made the motion to approve with a second by Council Member Ward. The motion passed unanimously.**

4. **Approval of Minutes from Previous Meeting**:

Minutes of January 10, 2024

Mayor Williams asked for a motion to approve the meeting minutes of January 10, 2024. **Council Member Ward made the motion to approve with meeting minutes January 10, 2024. Council Member Crenshaw provided the second. The motions passed unanimously.**

5. **Presentation:**

a) Roger Moss, SCCPSS Board President – Mr. Moss discussed the state of Savannah-Chatham County Schools. He stated the school board has revamped the reading programs for schools and are going back to a phonics approach. He stated the purpose of education is to give children choice-filled lives. He is excited for the changes and the growth of the school system.
b) Mayor Williams read the Black History Month proclamation. Mayor Williams presented the proclamations to Roger Moss, Ms. Clemens, Ms. Hayes, and Ms. Dickerson.
c) Mayor Williams read the Officer Benjamin Green Day Proclamation. Mayor Williams presented copies to Ms. Clemens, Ms. Dickerson, and Ms. Duncan-Norman. Officer Green was not in attendance.
d) Mayor Williams read the "Know Local-Go Local" business spotlight for March 2024. The business being recognized in March are: Michael Gaster & Associates, Chiriya & Son, Keith Ray Construction, and Dogtopia of Thunderbolt.

6. **Finance Report:**

Shannon Brett, Holland, Bromley, Barnhill & Brett, discussed the Town's Finance Report.

7. **Consent Agenda:**

a) Consideration to Approve Emily McCarthy, LLC Alcohol License
b) Consideration to Approve CEMA Intergovernmental Agreement

A motion was made by Council Member Ward to approve all items on the Consent Agenda. Council Member Crenshaw provided the second. The motion passed unanimously.

8. **Discussion Agenda:**

a) Simply Savannah Marketing Contract

Council Member Ward made a motion to approve with a second by Council Member Crenshaw. The motion passed unanimously.

9. **Department Report** – Written Reports Submitted

by: **Police / Municipal Court / Neighborhood Watch – Sean Clayton, Chief of Police**
Chief Clayton had nothing further to add.

Fire –Fire Chief, Andrew Bateman
Chief Bateman was not in attendance.

Public Works Department – Oscar Crosby, Public Works Manager
Public Works Director Crosby had nothing further to add to his report.

Town Clerk – Matthew Walker, Town Clerk
Clerk Walker had nothing further to add to his report.

10. **Town Administrator Report:** Town Administrator, Bob Milie

Town Administrator Milie went over some highlights from his report. He also discussed roads, parks, water billing, and signage.

11. **Legal Report** – Town Attorney, Charlie Barrow

Nothing to report or discuss

12. **Mayor and Council –**

Council Member Ward discussed his desire for volunteers to assist with the River Drive Marsh Cleanup efforts with dates TBD. He is requesting April 6, 2024 to be the date.

13. **Thunderbolt Museum**

Anna Maria Thomas stated the Oyster Roast event was a huge success. She thanked Dwight and Erica Davis, the Town of Thunderbolt Fire Department, and the many others who assisted in making the event such a great time.

14. **Executive Session-**

Council Member Ward made a motion at 7:46 pm to leave regular session to enter executive session to discuss Personnel, Property, or Litigation. Council Member Crenshaw seconded. The motion passed unanimously.

Council Member Crenshaw made a motion at 8:03 pm to leave executive session to return to regular session. Council Member Drohan seconded. The motion passed unanimously.

Mayor Williams asked for a motion to adjourn the meeting. **Council Member Crenshaw made the motion with a second from Council Member Ward. The motion passed unanimously.**

15. **Adjournment:**

The meeting adjourned at 8:04 pm.

Dana Williams, Mayor

Matthew D. Walker, Town Clerk

AFFIDAVIT

Personally appeared before the undersigned attesting officer, duly authorized to administer oaths, **Mayor, Dana Williams,** who, after being duly sworn, deposes and on oath states the following:

(1) I was the presiding officer of a meeting of the **Town of Thunderbolt** City Council held on the **14th** day **of February, 2024.**

(2) That it is my understanding that O.C.G.A. 50-14-4 (b) provides as follows:

> *When any meeting of an agency is closed to the public pursuant to subsection (a) of this Code Section the chairperson or other person presiding over such meeting shall execute and file with the official minutes of the meeting a notarized affidavit stating under oath that the subject matter of the meeting or the closed portion thereof was devoted to matters within the exceptions provided by law and identifying the specific relevant exception.*

(3) The subject matter of the closed meeting or closed portion of the meeting held on the **14th** day of **February, 2024** which was closed for the purpose of discussing Real Estate, *Personnel and/or Legal* Matters was devoted to matters within those exceptions as provided by law.

(4) This affidavit is being executed for the purpose of complying with the mandate of O.C.G.A. 50-14-4 (b) that such an affidavit be executed.

This 14th day of **February, 2024.**

Mayor, Dana Williams

Council Members

Sworn to and subscribed before me
this **14th** day of **February, 2024.**

Notary Public

SIGN IN SHEET

MEETING: BZA and Council Meeting **MEETING DATE:** February 14, 2024

NAME:	ADDRESS:
Beth Guvette	3006 Leonard Street
Sue DeRosa	3215 Bannon Dr.
meredith allen	3220 Fallsgant Ave.
Kerry DRESCHER	3111 Rowland AVE. Thunder Bay ON